

STEVE HEINKE

April 13, 2026

Experimental economist working on the cognitive and behavioral foundations of decision-making, with a focus on financial decision-making, information processing, attention, and learning.

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

02/2024–	Senior Researcher	Mobilier Center for Resilience University of Fribourg
02/2017–01/2024	Post-Doctoral Researcher	Center of Economic Psychology University of Basel
02/2011–01/2017	Research & Teaching Assistant	Department of Economics University of Zurich

EDUCATION

2011–2016	PhD in Economics	University of Zurich
2008–2011	Master & Graduate Studies in Economics	University of Munich
2005–2008	BA Philosophy & Economics	University of Bayreuth

PUBLICATIONS

1. **Mental Capabilities, Heterogeneous Trading Behaviour and Performance in an Experimental Asset Market**, with Andreas Hefti and Frédéric Schneider, *The Economic Journal*, 2025.
2. **Experiences, Demand for Risky Investments, and Implications for Price Dynamics**, with Sebastian Olschewski and Jörg Rieskamp, *Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Finance*, 2025.
3. **Top–Down and Bottom–Up Information Acquisition: Applications to Financial Markets**, *Economics Letters*, 2024.
4. **Degree of Personal Responsibility in Decisions and Investment Abandonment**, with Kevin Trutmann and Celine Rudin, *Journal of Behavioral Finance*, 2023.
5. **Take Your Time: Delayed Information and Belief Formation**, with Kevin Trutmann and Jörg Rieskamp, *Finance Research Letters*, 2023.
6. **Cognitive Abilities Affect Decision Errors but not Risk Preferences: A Meta-Analysis**, with Tehilla Mechera-Ostrovsky et al., *Psychonomic Bulletin & Review*, 2022.
7. **On the Economics of Superabundant Information and Scarce Attention**, with Andreas Hefti, *Oeconomia*, 2015.

WORKING PAPERS & MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW (selected)

1. **Avoiding Bad Risks: How Risk Aversion Is Beneficial for Financial Decision-Making** with Silvia Maier, Alexander Ziegler, Alexandra Bagaïni, Isabella Kooij, Stephan Nebe, Nikita Sidorenko, Kevin Trutmann, Thorsten Hens, Rui Mata, Philippe N. Tobler, and Jörg Rieskamp April 2026. Main paper of the interdisciplinary project “The Foundations of Successful Financial Decision Making”. Under review at *Management Science*. Working paper available upon request.
2. **The Elusive Neural Signature of Emotion Regulation Capabilities: Evidence from a Large-Scale Consortium**
with Carmen Morawetz (PI), Maurizio Sicorello (first author), and an international consortium analyzing 40 fMRI datasets. April 2026. First revision invited at *Nature*.

3. **The Robustness of Mental Accounting Around the World** with Enrico Rubaltelli (PI), Giulia Priolo (first author), and research teams from 21 countries. April 2026. Second revision invited at *Journal of Consumer Research*.
4. **What's Important Under the Hood? Decomposing Financial Decisions Through Structural Modeling** with Melvin Marti, Sebastian Olschewski, Kevin Trutmann, and Jörg Rieskamp. April 2026. Working paper in preparation for submission.
5. **Too Much Choice? A Lab-in-the-Field Experiment on Choice Overload, Cognitive Constraints, and Consumer Welfare in Electricity Contracts Decisions** with Sebastian Olschewski and Catherine Roux. March 2026. Under review at the *Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization*.
6. **How to Improve the Measurement Quality of Behavioral Tasks Eliciting Risk Preferences?** with Oliver Schürmann, Sandra Andraszewicz, and Jörg Rieskamp. January 2026. Under review at *Scientific Reports*.
7. **Belief Updating and Investment Decisions: The Impact of Good or Bad News Varies with Prior Returns** with Kevin Trutmann and Jörg Rieskamp. August 2023. Working paper.
8. **This Time Is Different: On Similarity and Risk Taking After Experienced Gains and Losses** with Adrian Leuenberger and Jörg Rieskamp. May 2021. Working paper.

Work in progress

1. Additional papers from the project "The Foundations of Successful Financial Decision Making" *Analysis completed, writing in progress*
2. Learn your limits
with Doron Cohen and Rudy de Winne, *Analysis completed, writing in progress*

INVITED SEMINARS

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| 2023 | Radboud-Universiteit Nijmegen; University of Warwick; ETH Zürich; University of Zürich; Maastricht University |
| 2022 | Columbia Business School |
| 2020 | Judge Business School, University of Cambridge; Maastricht University |
| 2019 | Lund University |

CONFERENCES

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| 2025 | ASSA, San Francisco (USA); Experimental Finance Conference, Maastricht (Netherlands); ESA Global Meeting, Beijing (China); Subjective Probability, Utility Decision Making, Lucca (Italy) |
| 2024 | Experimental Finance Conference, Stavanger (Norway); ESA Global Meeting, Bogotá (Columbia); Research in Behavioral Finance Conference, Amsterdam (Netherlands) |
| 2023 | Workshop on External Validity, Generalizability and Replicability of Economic Experiments, Barcelona (Spain); Experimental Finance Conference, Sofia (Bulgaria); ESA Global Meeting, Lyon (France); Subjective Probability, Utility Decision Making, Vienna (Austria) |
| 2022 | ESA Global Meeting, Boston (USA); Experimental Finance Conference, Bonn (Germany); Behavioral Measurement Conference, Frankfurt (Germany); Household Finance Workshop, Frankfurt (Germany); Foundations of Utility and Risk Conference, Ghent (Belgium); European Economic Science Association, Milano (Italy); Verein für Socialpolitik, Basel (Switzerland) |
| 2021 | Household Finance Workshop (Germany); Experimental Finance Workshop (Austria, online); ESA Global Online Around-the-Clock Conference (online); SPUDM, Warwick (UK, online); IAREP-SABE online conference (online) |
| 2020 | ESA junior faculty webinar (online); ESA Global Online Around-the-Clock Conference (online); |
| 2019 | Household Finance Workshop (Germany); Experimental Finance Workshop (Denmark) |
| 2018 | Household Finance Workshop (Germany); European Economic Science Association (Portugal); Experimental Finance Workshop (Germany) |
| 2017 | Household Finance Workshop (Germany); Experimental Finance Workshop (France), Spring Meeting of Young Economists (Germany) |
| 2012-16 | Zurich Workshop on Economics (Switzerland), Spring Meeting of Young Economists (Denmark), |

PROFESSIONAL SERVICES

Editorial Board	Journal of Behavioral Decision Making (2023-present)
Reviewed manuscripts	Finance Research Letters, Information Sciences, Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Finance, Journal of Behavioral Decision Making, Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization, Journal of Economic Psychology, Management Science, Psychological Review, SAGE Open, Spanish Journal of Accounting and Finance
University of Fribourg	Organizer Public Lecture Series on Resilience (2024-today) Organizer – Research Colloquium (2024-today) Organizer – Workshop (2024-today) Responsible – Webpage, LinkedIN (2024-today)
University of Basel	Research Committee of the Senate (2020-2024) Coordinator – Research Colloquium (2020-2024)
University of Zurich	Co-Organizer – Zurich Workshop on Economics (2013,2014)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Lecture	Economic Psychology (Bachelor, every Fall 2024, 2025)
Lecture	Risk in Modern Life (Bachelor, every Spring 2022 - 2026)
Seminar	Behavioral and Experimental Finance (Master, every Spring 2017-2023)
Seminar	Economic History (Bachelor, Spring 2015)
Seminar	Contract Theory and Information Economics (Master, Spring 2011,2012)
Seminar	Writing & Presentation Skills for Economists (Bachelor, Fall and Spring 2007,2008)
Seminar	Empirical Projectseminar (Bachelor, Fall and Spring 2017,2018)
Tutorial	Microeconomics I (Bachelor, Fall 2014, 2015)
Tutorial	Contract and Information Economics (Bachelor, Fall 2011,2012,2013)
Tutorial	Macroeconomics (Bachelor, Fall and Spring 2009,2010)
Theses	Master (8x), BA (34x)